[METRIC]

A-A-2995
December 27, 1996

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF, SPRING BACK

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in lieu of Federal specification UU-B-368, which is canceled.

1. Scope. This specification covers loose leaf binders which are side opening, closed (nonseparable) spring-back type, designed for firm retention of papers when closed. The binders are equipped with a pressboard folder.

2. Salient characteristics.

2.1. Construction. Each binder shall be constructed to withstand the strains, jars, and other conditions incident to shipping, storage, and severe office service. The binder shall consist of two stiff covers and a closed rounded back, containing four steel springs. Back and covers shall be bound with coated cloth. Coated cloth shall be one piece of material without splices, scratches, tears or cuts. Binders shall be side-opening and shall be designed and constructed in a manner that the back expands or opens sufficiently to permit insertion and removal of sheets of a quantity in accordance with the full capacity of the binder. Covers shall open and spring back to closed position in the normal manner. Each binder shall be equipped with an inner removable pressboard folder.

2.1.1. Size and capacity. Unless otherwise specified, the binder shall be not less than 28 x 21.6 cm (11" x 8-1/2") sheet size (the first dimension being the binding side), and have a minimum of 5.1 cm (2") capacity.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document, should be sent to: General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, 26 Federal Plaza, New York N.Y. 10278 ATTN: Engineering Branch (2FYEE).

FSC 7510

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2.1.2. Covers. Covers shall be made of book cover board bound with coated cloth securely glued to the entire area of contact with the back and covers. The binding material shall be carried over the inside surfaces of the covers at least 1.6 cm (5/8") beyond the edges. A paper lining shall be securely glued to the inner surfaces of the covers and shall overlap the edges of the binding material at least 1 cm (3/8") and the edges of canvas reinforcement extending from the back, approximately 5 cm (2"), (see 2.1.3). All corners of the nonbinding side of the binder shall be rounded.

2.1.3. Back and springs (binding mechanism). Back shall be of pressboard, rounded, and joined to the covers by the binding material and the canvas lining of the back. The interior of the back shall be lined with a double thickness of canvas which shall extend over the inner surfaces of the covers at least 5.72 cm (2-1/4"). The exterior of the back, under the binding material, shall be cushioned with red flexible board which shall extend over the entire pressboard back and the metal strips. The binder shall contain four round, steel springs spaced along the binding edge of the pressboard back, encased in the red flexible board, and sealed with two metal strips mounted on edges of the pressboard back. Springs shall be 3.18 ± 0.16 cm (1-1/4 ± 1/16") long, (along binding edge), with ends terminating on the two metal strips along the pressboard back. Spacing of the springs shall be in accordance with normal commercial practice.

2.1.4. Pressboard Folders. Folders shall be of one piece construction and shall be approximately 28 x 48 cm (11" x 19") in size. Folders shall be shaped and scored parallel to the binding edge of binder in a manner to fit the back and remainder of the binder, as applicable, in a snug manner and to accept and enclose applicable size and number of sheets ranging to the full capacity of the binder. Folders shall be inserted in the binder and shall be the manufacturer's normal commercial color.

2.2. Materials. Binders shall meet the following requirements specified herein.

2.2.1. Book cover board. The book cover board shall have a minimum thickness of 2.97 mm (0.117"), and have a minimum bursting strength of 2,963 kPascals (415 psi).

2.2.2. Pressboard.

2.2.2.1. Back. Pressboard shall be 0.76 mm (0.030") in thickness ±0.08 mm (± 0.003"), with the minimum Bursting Strength of 2,355 kPa (330 psi).

2.2.2.2. Folder. Pressboard shall be 0.38 mm (0.015") in thickness ±0.08 mm (± 0.003"), with the minimum Bursting Strength of 1,240 kPa (180 psi).

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2.2.3. Coated Cloth.

2.2.3.1. Base Cloth. The base cloth shall be cotton drill coated on the face side as specified in 2.2.3.2.

2.2.3.2. Coating Compound. The base cloth shall be coated with any commercially available virgin plastic.

2.2.3.3. Finished Coated Cloth. The breaking strength shall be at least 34 pounds in both warp and filling directions. The weight shall be 375, +68, -34 gm/m^2 (11.07, +2,-1 oz/yd^2). Colorfastness shall be at least "Good".

2.2.3.4. Flexibility. The coated cloth shall be sufficiently soft and pliable for binder operations. The coating shall not crack through to the base cloth.

2.2.3.5. Color and finish. The coated cloth shall be black and shall have a grain or finish simulating that of genuine leather.

2.2.4. Steel (springs). Steel shall be 1075 Annealed Spring Steel, 0.432 ± 0.02 mm (0.017 ± 0.001") thick, hardened and tempered to a Rockwell Superficial Hardness of 69-72 on the 30-N Scale.

2.2.5. Canvas. The breaking strength shall be at least 445 Newtons (100 pounds) in warp direction, and 267 Newtons (60 pounds) in filling direction. Canvas shall be cotton (Army) duck consisting of 2-ply yarns in both the warp and filling direction. The duck shall have a finished weight of not less than 237 gm/m^2 (7.0 oz/yd^2). Colorfastness shall be at least "Fair". Canvas shall be black or blue.

2.2.6. Red flexible board (reinforcement). Red flexible board reinforcement material of back shall be at least 0.762 mm (0.030") thick.

2.2.7. Paper lining. Paper lining shall have a basis weight of at least 98 g/m^2 (60 lb_m based on 24" x 36" - 500 sheets). The color of the lining shall harmonize with the binding material.

2.3. Identification marking. The manufacturer's name of trademark of such known character as to be readily identifiable, shall be printed, heat stamped , or otherwise permanently marked on the inside of one cover of the binder. When specified, the words "Property of U.S. Government," or any additional marking shall be included in the marking.

2.4. Workmanship. Binders shall open and close easily during the normal use, and shall be well finished, with clean, and smooth edges. Corners shall be neatly pleated or turned in accordance with normal commercial practice. Binders shall be free from any defects which may affect its serviceability or appearance.

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3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS:

3.1 Certification (paperboard). The contractor shall certify that the paperboard used in the manufacture of this item contains a minimum of 80 % Post Consumer Recovered Material (PCRM), in accordance with Code 40 of the Federal Regulations Part 247, Comprehensive Guideline for Procurement of Products Containing Recovered Materials; Final Rule. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery, and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

4.1. Product conformance. The product provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

5. PACKAGING, PACKING AND MARKING: Packing, packing and marking shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS: The issue of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

6.1. CFR, Title 40, Code of Federal Regulations, Protection of the Environment, Part 247. Copies may be purchased with a VISA, Master Card or prepaid check through: Government Printing Office, Washington DC; Phone 202-783-3238. When ordering ask for: Title 40, Parts 190-250; Stock Number: 869-013-00-146-0.

6.2. Federal Standards & Specifications may be obtained from the General Services Administration Specifications Section (3FBO-W) in Suite 8100 at L'Enfant Plaza, SW, Washington DC 20407.

6.3. American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) methods, can be obtained from: American Society for Testing and Materials; 1916 Race Street; Philadelphia, PA 19103.

6.4. Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry (TAPPI) methods, can be obtained from: Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/ Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, GA 30348.

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7. NOTES.

7.1. ORDERING DATA. Purchasers should specify the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

7.1. Title, number and date of this specification.
7.2. Sheet size and capacity of the binder required.
7.3. Color of binder required.
7.4. Spacing of metal fasteners required.
7.5. Type and thickness of the pressboard required.
7.6. Unit of issue and quantity required.
7.7. Packaging, packing, marking and special marking required.

7.2. NATIONAL STOCK NUMBER LISTING (NSN'S). The following is a list of nsn's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible nsn's associated with the CID.

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User Interest:

Army - GL

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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